

Employee Handbook

Northwind Trading Co. · People Policy · Effective 1 July 2026

1. Annual leave

Every full-time employee receives **22 paid vacation days** per calendar year, accrued monthly from the start date.

- After two full years of service, one extra day is added per two years, up to a maximum of **27 days**.
- Up to **5 unused days** may carry into the next year. Carried days expire on **31 March** and are not paid out.
- Requests of five days or more need manager approval at least **three weeks** in advance.
- Part-time staff accrue leave pro rata based on contracted hours.

2. Sick leave

Employees receive **10 paid sick days** per year, separate from vacation. A doctor's note is required from the **fourth consecutive day** of absence.

- Unused sick days do not carry over and are not paid out.
- Notify your manager before **09:30** on the first day of absence.

3. Remote and hybrid work

Employees may work remotely up to **three days per week**. **Tuesday is the required in-office day** for every team, with the company all-hands at **10:00**.

- Working from outside your country of employment needs written HR approval and is limited to **20 working days** per year.
- A one-off **\$150 home-office stipend** is available after the probation period.

4. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive **16 weeks** of fully paid leave. Secondary caregivers receive **4 weeks**. Both must be taken within 12 months of birth or adoption.

5. Expenses

Claims must be submitted within **30 days** of the spend date. Receipts are required for anything over **\$25**.

- Meals while travelling are capped at **\$45 per day**.
- Flights and hotels must be booked at least **14 days** ahead unless the trip is urgent and approved by a director.
- Reimbursements are paid with the next monthly payroll run on the **25th**.

6. Probation, notice and reviews

The probation period is **three months**, extendable once by a further six weeks. After probation the notice period is **four weeks** on either side.

- Performance reviews run twice a year, in **February** and **August**.
- Each employee has a **\$1,200 annual training budget**; unused budget does not carry over.
- Company laptops are refreshed every **three years**.

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